

LA.5 Forms & Documents Index

Every document you will be asked for, named as the office that issues it names it — and the short list of things that need no permit at all.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Louisiana writes one mandatory construction code for the whole state and then hands enforcement to each parish and municipality, which is why the code your house must meet is the same in Cameron Parish as in Caddo while the office that inspects it, the forms it hands you and the fee it charges are not. Confirm every local item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it.

THE DOCUMENTS

Louisiana routes an owner-builder through four different levels of government — a state licensing board, a state health office, your parish or town, and in some cases the state highway department and the state environmental agency. Nothing arrives in one packet. This is the whole set.

Licensing and the exemption

Document	From	What it is, and when
Affidavit Claiming Exemption from Licensure	State Licensing Board for Contractors	The document that gets an owner-builder a permit. Notarized, eleven initialed statements. It carries no form number — only a revision date, which was 1 August 2025 when this kit was verified. Goes to your local permit official <i>before</i> the permit issues.
Church Owner/Builder Affidavit	State Licensing Board for Contractors	Not your form. It implements a different exemption and sits on the same forms page. Confusingly, the words “Owner/Builder” appear in its title and not in yours.
Written subcontractor contracts	You	Not a state form, but a statutory requirement you attest to on the affidavit: a signed written contract with each licensed sub, with no work beginning before all parties sign.
License verification printout	State Licensing Board for Contractors	The board runs a public contractor search. Print the result for each sub and keep it with the contract — your exemption does not cover them.

The building permit

Document	From	What it is, and when
Building permit application	Your parish or municipality	In several parishes this form is physically issued by the 911 office , which completes and signs part of it before you take it anywhere else. Ask where the form comes from, not just where it goes.
Construction plans	You or your designer	One to two sets. No architect or engineer seal may be required if the house is within the IRC's prescriptive standards. At least one parish also asks for a Manual J load calculation.
Site plan	You	May be hand drawn. See the note under the sewage permit below — the health office says so in writing.
Legal description / parcel listing	Tax assessor or clerk of court	Several parishes ask for the current parcel listing from the assessor.
Property plat	Surveyor, or clerk of court	The health office needs a plat bearing a Louisiana surveyor's seal or designated a "true copy" by the clerk of court . The second route means an existing recorded plat can satisfy this without a new survey.
911 / E-911 address assignment	Parish 911 district, sheriff, or permit office	Usually the first step in the whole process. One parish will not assign the address until the front door is in place — ask early what triggers it.
Certificate of occupancy	Your permitting authority	Notify them of completion before anyone occupies. On a new-construction mortgage the lender records it in the parish conveyance records, and you owe the lender a copy.

Sewage and water

Document	From	What it is, and when
LHS-47 — Application for Permit for Installation of On-Site Wastewater Disposal System	Parish health unit (state health office)	The application and the stage-one temporary permit in one document. Filled out at the health unit — not a blank download. Valid one year ; ask for an extension if the build slips.
SF-10ST — Applicant Notification and Acknowledgement	Parish health unit	Signed by you. This is the form that states the owner-install rule: you must do the actual installation, and hiring an unlicensed person for any part of it voids the exception.
SF-11ST — Perpetual Maintenance Acknowledgement	Parish health unit	Signed by you.

Sewage and water

Document	From	What it is, and when
FORM-A — Lot Size Requirements	Parish health unit	Informational, and worth reading before you buy a lot — the statewide minimum is 22,500 sq ft with 125 ft of frontage unless your parish qualifies for the reduced sizes.
FORM-B — Directions to Property	Parish health unit	A sanitarian is coming out to survey the site. Mark your property boundaries clearly so they can see where the lot ends.
Certification by Installer	Your licensed installer	Due within 15 days of completion. If you installed the system yourself you are not a licensed installer, so your final approval runs through the sanitarian's on-site inspection instead.
Water well notification	State water administration office	For a domestic well in a non-critical ground water area, due within 60 days after installation — and the driller's own 30-day registration satisfies it.
DNR-GW-1S — Water Well Registration Short Form	Your licensed water well contractor	Registration is the contractor's duty, not yours. Ask for a copy for your file anyway.

Site, access and hazards

Document	From	What it is, and when
Access Connection Permit Certificate	State highway department district	Required where your driveway ties into a state or US route. There is a residential version of the form. It asks for culvert diameter, length and material, so lay the site out first.
Culvert / driveway permit	Parish public works	The parish equivalent, for a parish-maintained road. Several parishes make it a precondition to the building permit.
Flood zone determination	Parish floodplain manager	In Louisiana this is usually the same person who signs your building permit. Several parishes publish a dedicated request form.
Elevation Certificate	Licensed surveyor	In a Special Flood Hazard Area expect to need it twice — a proposed certificate before the permit and a final one before the certificate of occupancy. Book the surveyor early.
LDEQ notice of intent — construction stormwater	State environmental agency	If the project will disturb one acre or more. Clearing, grading and the driveway all count toward it.
LDEQ discharge coverage	State environmental agency	If your system discharges treated effluent to the surface rather than to a subsurface field.

WHAT NEEDS NO PERMIT — AND THE TRAP INSIDE IT

Louisiana carves a few things out of code enforcement. Read the exclusions inside the carve-outs, because they are where people get caught.

Farm structures and recreational structures — but not a house

A parish “shall not enforce that portion of the Uniform Construction Code which regulates the construction or improvement of a farm structure or private outdoor recreational structure, **other than a residence or structure attached to a residence.**” And the definition closes the same door again: a farm structure is one built on a farm “**other than a residence**” or a structure attached to it.

So the barn may be exempt. **The house on the farm is not.** Do not let anyone tell you that building on agricultural land exempts the dwelling.

Small accessory buildings — with a south-Louisiana exception

Detached accessory structures at or under **200 square feet** can fall outside enforcement — **but not in hurricane-prone regions where the ultimate design wind speed is 130 mph or greater**, which is a great deal of south Louisiana. Check your parcel's design wind speed before relying on the exemption; it is the same number you needed for the house.

And note the statute's own backstop: these exemptions “do[es] not affect the power of the governing authority of a parish or municipality to issue building permits” for such structures anyway. Exempt from the *code* is not the same as exempt from the *permit*. Ask before you build.

One more that is genuinely a different track rather than an exemption: a **manufactured home** built to federal HUD standards is not built to the state code, but its installation is regulated, the installing plumber must be Louisiana-licensed, and a jurisdiction that collects a placement fee must inspect the installation. If you are placing rather than building, that is a different set of paperwork than this kit covers.

WHERE TO GET ALL OF IT

Four sources cover almost everything above, and all four are free.

- **Islbc.gov** — the State Licensing Board for Contractors: the exemption affidavit, the forms page, and the public contractor search you should be running on every sub.
- **Isuccc.la** — the Uniform Construction Code Commission: the compiled law and rules volume, the current code editions and their effective dates, and the public search that confirms your jurisdiction and lists the inspectors licensed to work in it.
- **Your parish health unit** — every sewage form in this index. They are not downloads; you get them where you apply.
- **Your parish or municipal permit office** — the building permit application, the culvert permit, the flood determination, and the answer to every question this kit tells you to ask

locally. LA.4 has the page to write those answers on.

Sources — every Louisiana claim in this document (verified September 2026)

What this document states	Authority
Affidavit title, revision date, notarization and eleven statements	LSLBC, Affidavit Claiming Exemption from Licensure
The affidavit goes to the local permit official before issuance	R.S. 37:2157(A)(13); R.S. 37:2160(C)
Written subcontractor contracts before work begins	La. R.S. 37:2159(A), (B)
No architect or engineer stamp for a prescriptive IRC house	R.S. 37:3737(D)
LHS-47 is the application and temporary permit	LAC 51:XIII.731.D, 733.C.8; LDH form SF-10ST
Temporary permit valid one year; extension on request	OPH applicant packet
Site plan may be hand drawn; plat needs a seal or a clerk's true copy	OPH applicant packet, Steps One and Two
Certification by Installer due within 15 days	LAC 51:XIII.701.C
Minimum lot area and frontage	LAC 51:XIII.511.B.4
Domestic well notification within 60 days after installation	LAC 43:VI.701.C
Well registration is the contractor's duty; short form for domestic wells	LAC 56:I.105.A, D
Farm structures exempt, other than a residence	R.S. 37:3738(B)(1)(a), (B)(2)
Accessory structures at 200 sq ft, excluded in 130 mph wind regions	R.S. 37:3738(B)(1)(b)
Exemption does not affect the power to issue building permits	R.S. 37:3738(B)(4)
Manufactured homes run on federal standards plus state installation rules	R.S. 37:3737(B); R.S. 37:3738(G)
Certificate of occupancy recorded by the lender	R.S. 37:3737(E)(1)–(2)

Everything cited here is free to read. A **R.S.** citation is a Louisiana Revised Statute — search the number at legis.la.gov under Louisiana Laws. A **LAC** citation is the Louisiana Administrative Code, published as free PDFs by the Office of the State Register at doa.la.gov. Rules newer than the last codified printing appear only in the Louisiana Register at the same site, so check there before relying on a date. Read September 2026.